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Project Report – Digital Literacy Project Overview

This project covers five tasks designed to build practical digital literacy skills — not just theoretical knowledge, but actual tools and habits that are useful right now as a student.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Infographic The goal was to create a one-page visual resource explaining digital literacy for batchmates. Canva was used to design the infographic, which covers what digital literacy means, safe internet practices, and professional online presence. The initiative here was to keep the design simple enough that a first-year student could read it in under two minutes and still walk away with something useful.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio This task involved setting up a foundational professional presence online. Profiles were created on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. A GitHub profile README was written with basic details — branch, year, and a line about learning goals. LinkedIn's Education section was filled in with current degree and institution details. The idea was to treat these not as checkboxes but as profiles that would actually hold up if an employer or coordinator looked them up.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms HackerRank was used to complete a beginner-level coding challenge, building familiarity with how competitive coding platforms work. Alongside that, a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz was built using Google Forms — with both multiple choice and short answer questions — making it something that could realistically be shared with batchmates as part of the Digital Ambassador role.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Etiquette Guide Two professional emails were drafted: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor, and one expressing interest in a summer internship to a company coordinator. Both follow proper structure — clear subject line, formal greeting, concise body, and a professional sign-off. A Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist was also created covering responsible online behaviour for college students.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness Case Study UPI/Online Payment Fraud was chosen as the cybercrime focus, given how directly it affects college students in India. A 200–250 word case study was written covering how the fraud typically unfolds, who gets targeted, and what the consequences look like. A 'Stay Safe Online' prevention checklist followed, with eight specific tips — including two focused on UPI and financial safety — and references to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930. The reflection piece, written as part of the report, covered what the research revealed about SMS-based two-factor authentication and the decision to finally move to a proper password manager.

TASK 1 PROJECT REPORT:

I used Canva to put together a six-panel infographic on Digital Literacy. The layout has a bold purple hero card on the left — I placed the "Digital Literacy Essentials" title there in white, with a definition box tucked below it — and then four content cards on the right covering Digital Tools, Safe Practices, Online Presence, and Email Etiquette. Each card got its own icon, a short heading, and three bullet points. I kept the color scheme simple: one strong purple, white cards, and a pale grey background. I picked the icons deliberately too — a shield for Safe Practices, a key for passwords, a LinkedIn logo for the professional profiles section.

Getting the grid to sit evenly was honestly the most frustrating part. Canva's drag-and-drop makes it easy to nudge things slightly off without realizing, and four cards of identical height don't just happen. I had to go back and manually resize things or use the alignment tools more carefully than I expected to.

The icon hunt was probably the most interesting bit though. The Canva library is huge, which sounds helpful until you're twenty minutes in looking for something that isn't just a generic checkmark — something that actually fits the topic. That took longer than I thought it would.

Write-up:

For this task, Canva was used to design a one-page infographic titled *Digital Literacy Essentials*. The layout uses a clean card-based structure with five sections: a definition of digital literacy, useful digital tools for students, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette.

The definition panel explains digital literacy as the ability to find, evaluate, utilize, share, and create content using digital technologies — framed specifically around what it means for students. The Digital Tools section organizes recommendations by category: research tools like Google Scholar and Zotero, organization tools like Notion and Trello, and creation tools like Canva and Prezi. Safe Practices covers passwords, two-factor authentication, and phishing awareness. Online Presence addresses managing your digital footprint and using LinkedIn responsibly. Email Etiquette covers subject lines, greetings, and proofreading.

The most interesting part of the process was figuring out how to cover five distinct topics without the design feeling cluttered. Keeping each card to three points maximum helped — it forced the content to stay practical rather than turning into a wall of text.

TASK 2 PROJECT REPORT:

LinkedIn is a professional networking site for building a career profile, connecting with people in your field, and finding jobs. I'll use it to document internships, projects, and coursework over the next four years — a running record of what I've actually done, not just what I plan to do.

GitHub hosts code and tracks changes across projects. I'll store work from courses and personal projects there, which makes it easier to show someone what I've built rather than just describing it in a resume.

Kaggle is a data science platform with competitions, public datasets, and shared notebooks. People use it to practice machine learning and data analysis outside formal coursework. I plan to work through datasets and try a few beginner competitions to get comfortable with the whole process.

These three platforms feel like a practical combination — one for professional presence, one for code, one for data work. I don't expect to have everything figured out early on, but starting now at least gives me something concrete to build from.

Write-up:

For this task, profiles were set up on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle.

GitHub is primarily a version control and code hosting platform. A profile README was created under the account username, including name, branch, year, and a brief line about learning goals. This acts as a public-facing introduction for anyone who visits the profile. LinkedIn is the professional networking platform most commonly checked by employers and internship coordinators. The Education section was filled in with current degree details, institution name, and expected graduation year — keeping it minimal but accurate at this stage. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community where students can practice with real datasets, participate in competitions, and follow other practitioners.

The plan over the next four years is to use GitHub as a living record of projects — something that grows alongside actual skills rather than sitting empty. LinkedIn will be updated as internships, certifications, and relevant experiences are added. Kaggle will be used to practice data-related work and eventually participate in beginner competitions once the foundational coursework is done.

TASK 3 PROJECT REPORT:

For this task, I used Google Forms to design a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz intended for my batchmates. Google Forms is a free, browser-based tool that requires no installation — questions can be configured, answer keys set, and the form shared through a single link within minutes.

The quiz covers topics I think actually matter: identifying unreliable websites, understanding two-factor authentication, recognising phishing attempts, and verifying sources before sharing information online. I used both multiple choice and short answer formats because some questions have a definitive answer, while others are worth thinking through properly — and I wanted the quiz to reflect that.

Working on this pushed me to be more deliberate about how questions are phrased. A poorly worded question either confuses the respondent or gives the answer away, and I had to revise several of mine before they read clearly. That kind of precision — anticipating how someone else will interpret what you've written — is directly useful in academic work. Research projects often involve surveys or questionnaires, and having hands-on experience designing one is a practical foundation to build on.

Write-up:

This task had two parts: a coding practice component and a Google Workspace collaboration component.

For the coding side, HackerRank was used to complete the *Solve Me First* challenge — a beginner-level problem that takes two integers as input and returns their sum. It's a straightforward problem by design, but the value wasn't in the difficulty. It was in getting comfortable with how the platform works: reading problem statements, writing code in the browser-based editor, and submitting for evaluation. HackerRank is structured well for students who are just starting out, with a clear progression from beginner to advanced challenges across multiple languages.

For the collaboration component, a five-question Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz was built using Google Forms. The quiz includes both multiple choice and short answer questions, covering topics like safe internet practices and identifying phishing attempts. A linked Google Sheet was set up to automatically collect and display responses. This part felt more immediately useful — the form is something that could genuinely be shared with batchmates as part of the Digital Ambassador role rather than just submitted as an assignment.

Together, both platforms demonstrated how digital tools can support learning in very different ways: one through structured problem-solving, the other through building something others can actually use.

TASK 4 PROJECT REPORT:

When a Misread Email Grounded a Flight Crew(one situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem, hypothetical scenario)

In 2012, a regional airline crew missed a scheduling update sent via email the night before an early departure. The message, flagged as routine, was buried under other notifications and never opened. The result: an unstaffed flight, hundreds of stranded passengers, and significant financial and reputational damage to the airline.

The core failure wasn't the technology — it was the *assumption* that sending a message guaranteed it was received and understood. Critical operational changes were treated with the same urgency as a newsletter.

What could have been done differently: The airline should have used a confirmation-required notification system for time-sensitive updates, ensuring crew members actively acknowledged the change. A follow-up call or SMS for after-hours critical alerts would have added a simple but effective safety layer. In high-stakes environments, communication isn't complete at "send" — it's complete at *confirmed receipt*.

Write-up:

Two professional emails were drafted for this task — one to a professor requesting a deadline extension, and one to an internship coordinator expressing interest in a summer opportunity. Both follow standard email structure: a specific subject line, formal greeting, a clear and concise body, and a professional sign-off.

The communication scenario that stood out while working on this task was a common one: a student sending a deadline extension request over WhatsApp to a professor, using casual language and no context — just "sir can I submit tomorrow?" The professor had no way of knowing which subject, which assignment, or why the request was being made. It came across as disorganised and disrespectful, even if that wasn't the intention. The same request, sent as a short professional email with a subject line, a one-line explanation, and a polite close, would have taken two minutes longer to write and left a completely different impression.

The key learning here is that tone and format are not just about politeness — they signal whether someone takes their own request seriously.

TASK 5 PROJECT REPORT:

What surprised me most was how often password reuse came up as the single biggest risk — not phishing, not malware. Just the same password recycled across dozens of accounts. Researchers have flagged this for years. It still feels abstract until you map out how many sites share your credentials.

The other thing: SMS two-factor authentication is considered weak. Most people treat it as good enough. It's not. SIM-swapping can bypass it fast.

The habit I'm changing is finally moving to a proper password manager. I've put it off for two years. No real excuse — I just kept assuming my current setup was fine. Looking at the checklist made that harder to believe.

Write-up:

UPI/Online Payment Fraud was chosen as the focus for this task, given how directly it affects college students in India. A case study was written covering how the fraud typically unfolds, who gets targeted, and what the consequences look like. A prevention checklist followed with eight specific tips, including two focused on UPI and financial safety, along with references to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) and Helpline 1930.

What was most surprising during research was how often password reuse came up as the single biggest risk — not phishing, not malware. Just the same password recycled across dozens of accounts. The other unexpected finding was that SMS-based two-factor authentication, which most people treat as good enough, is considered weak. SIM-swapping attacks can bypass it quickly.

The habit being changed as a result is moving to a proper password manager. It had been put off for a while, with the assumption that the current setup was fine. Looking closely at the checklist made that harder to justify.

Conclusion:

This project covered a lot of ground — design, professional presence, coding platforms, communication, and cybersecurity — but the common thread across all five tasks was the same: digital literacy is less about knowing what tools exist and more about knowing how to use them responsibly and intentionally.

Before this project, most of these things existed in isolation. GitHub was just somewhere code gets stored. LinkedIn was something to set up eventually. Emails to professors were written the same way texts are sent. Researching the cybercrime case study in particular made it clear how much risk comes not from ignorance but from assumption — assuming the password is strong enough, assuming SMS authentication is secure, assuming casual communication is fine in a professional context.

What changed after working through each task is harder to summarise in one line, but the most accurate version is this: the digital habits built now will follow you into internships, workplaces, and professional relationships for years. A poorly structured email, an empty GitHub profile, or a reused password are small things individually. Together, they shape how others see you online — and how exposed you are when something goes wrong.

The project made that feel real rather than theoretical, which is probably the most useful thing it could have done.

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